

Rising intensity, and what drives it

The PN's reading of Eurostat's greenhouse gas intensity figures, tested

THE CLAIM

“Malta is the only EU Member State which ... increased the intensity of greenhouse gas emissions from 2013 ...”

Partit Nazzjonalista press release, signed by Eve Borg Bonello, 26 January 2026

It cites Eurostat (Malta +17%, EU –34%) and blames weak ambition on renewable energy.

Our translation of the Maltese release. Eurostat's 2024 values are estimates.

VERDICT

MISLEADING

*Eurostat's figure is right;
the rise is airline fuel.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+14%

Only rise in the EU

Eurostat's indicator, 2013–2024 (+17% in January); EU –34%. 2024 is an estimate.

72%

Airline fuel bought abroad

Share of Malta's 2024 figure; firms resident in Malta are counted wherever they fly.

–64%

Without air transport

The same indicator, 2013–2024: the EU's second-largest fall.

–61%

Territorial inventory

Emissions in Malta per euro of GDP, 2013–2024: again second-best in the EU.

–56%

Electricity emissions

Where renewables act, emissions fell; the whole rise is air transport.

FAIR TO SAY

The PN quoted Eurostat's own headline correctly. Malta's renewable shares are low (10.7% of electricity, the EU's lowest). The issue is what the figure counts.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The PN's source for “third from last”.

☐ Which other “fronts” the PN had in mind.

☐ Which airline operations drive the series.

☐ Malta's reported 2024 accounts.